

How joints work

A joint is formed wherever two or more bones meet. Most joints, such as those in the fingers, are synovial joints. These allow the bones to move freely and give the skeleton its flexibility. Other joints, such as the semimovable and fixed joints, provide stability to the skeleton.

Flexible joint

This view inside a synovial joint shows how it works. The bone ends are covered by slippery cartilage and separated by oily synovial fluid. Together, these allow the joint to move easily and smoothly. A tough capsule holds the joint in place.

Ligaments help the capsule to hold the joint together

